Junior IAM Administrator
Interview Questions & Answers

Farhan Muntasir | System One virtual screening | November 7, 2026

Practice transcript compiled from this conversation. Candidate answers preserve the distinction between hands-on labs, transferable operational experience, and proposed production workflows. Recruiter-assistant replies below are summarized from the supplied screenshots; they are not independently confirmed employer commitments.

1. Describe your hands-on experience managing users, groups, or applications in Microsoft Entra (formerly Azure AD).

My hands-on experience with Microsoft Entra ID comes from practical IAM labs, supported by my SC-300 certification. I've created and managed users, security groups, and dynamic groups, assigned licenses, and configured group-based application access.

I've also practiced configuring MFA, self-service password reset, Conditional Access policies, and guest access reviews. My application integration labs include SAML single sign-on and OpenID Connect, where I tested authentication and reviewed configuration issues.

I document my lab configurations and verification results on GitHub. This experience has given me a strong foundation in identity administration, troubleshooting, and least-privilege access that I'm ready to apply in a production support role.

2. How have you provisioned or de-provisioned access for identities such as service accounts or service principals in a previous role?

My experience with service identities comes from hands-on labs rather than a previous production role. In my Microsoft Entra ID labs, I practiced using managed identities for scenarios such as allowing an Azure virtual machine to access Key Vault, with permissions scoped to the required resource.

For a service principal, my approach would be to confirm the application owner and business requirement, assign the minimum necessary permissions, and test the intended access.

For de-provisioning, I would check application dependencies, remove role assignments and permissions, disable the identity where appropriate, and revoke its credentials. I would then verify that access was removed and document the changes.

3. Explain the difference between authentication and authorization in the context of single sign-on.

Authentication verifies who a user is, while authorization determines what that user can access and do.

With single sign-on, a user authenticates through an identity provider such as Microsoft Entra ID, potentially using MFA. Connected applications trust that identity provider, allowing the user to access them without entering credentials again.

Each application then enforces authorization based on assigned roles, groups, or permissions. For example, two employees might both sign in successfully through SSO, but one can only view reports while the other can edit them. Successful authentication does not automatically grant access to every application or feature.

4. Describe a situation where you troubleshot an account lockout or authentication failure in Active Directory.

I haven't handled an Active Directory account lockout in a production role yet, but I can explain how I would troubleshoot it based on my lab work and training.

First, I would confirm the error and check whether the account was locked, disabled, or had an expired password. For a lockout, I would review the domain controller's Security log for event ID 4740 to help identify the computer generating the attempts.

I would then investigate that computer for saved credentials, scheduled tasks, or services using an outdated password. After addressing the cause, I would unlock the account, test the user's sign-in, and monitor for another lockout. I would document the cause, resolution, and verification results.

5. How have you used an ITSM tool such as ServiceNow to handle access requests or incident tickets related to identity or authentication?

In my Amazon Area Manager role, I managed operational tickets and helped resolve issues. That gave me transferable experience with ticket management, although those weren't dedicated IAM help desk tickets. I haven't used ServiceNow in a production IAM role yet.

For an access request, I would verify the requester's identity, confirm the required access and approvals, and follow least-privilege principles before making changes. I would record the action taken and verify that the access worked as intended.

For an authentication incident, I would document the symptoms, assess the impact and urgency, investigate the relevant logs, and resolve or escalate the issue. I would keep the user informed and record the resolution before closing the ticket.

Candidate Questions & Recruiter Responses

6. Do you have any questions about the role or about System One and its subsidiaries?

Yes, thank you. What would be the main priorities for this role during the first 90 days, and what training or onboarding does the team provide?

I'd also like to know the next steps in the interview process and the expected timeline.

Virtual recruiter response - available summary

The assistant said the job context did not specify the number of interview rounds, who the candidate would meet next, or the expected decision or hiring timeline. It said it would flag these questions for the recruiter. A specific first-90-day plan and confirmed onboarding arrangements were not established in the supplied exchange.

7. Would you like to ask anything more specific about daily responsibilities, technologies, or qualifications?

Yes, thank you. Could you describe a typical day in this role and the most common identity or authentication issues the team handles? Which technologies would I work with most frequently, and what training is available for tools such as ADFS, YubiKey, HYPR, and LastPass?

Virtual recruiter response - responsibilities summarized

The screenshots describe processing operational tickets and access requests; investigating authentication failures and repeated AD account lockouts; supporting application integrations; reviewing application authentication and provisioning capabilities; evaluating permissions for least privilege; documenting dependencies and gaps; and coordinating client secret and certificate renewals with the Secrets Management team.

Recruiter Responses & Closing

Common issues and technologies - screenshot summary

Identity platforms: Microsoft Entra ID, Active Directory, AD LDS, and directory synchronization such as Entra Connect. Entra work includes users, groups, app registrations, enterprise applications, service principals, API permissions, and Conditional Access.

Authentication and federation: SAML 2.0, OpenID Connect, OAuth 2.0, Kerberos, Integrated Windows Authentication, and ADFS relying party trusts, claim rules, and certificates where used.

Common incidents: failed sign-ins or SSO; repeated account lockouts caused by stale credentials; synchronization problems; incorrect group or app assignments; excessive or missing API permissions; and Conditional Access blocks.

Other tools: YubiKey (FIDO2/PIV), HYPR, LastPass, PowerShell, Microsoft Graph PowerShell SDK, and an ITSM platform such as ServiceNow for requests, incidents, and changes.

Application reviews: supported authentication protocols; provisioning and de-provisioning options such as SCIM, just-in-time provisioning, or manual processes; required permissions; and integration dependencies. Just-in-time provisioning does not by itself establish an offboarding process.

Training and next steps - unresolved

The virtual assistant said the description did not specify formal training, vendor courses or labs, certification sponsorship, or the balance between structured training and on-the-job guidance. It said it would note the training question for the recruiter. These arrangements and the hiring timeline remain unconfirmed.

8. Is there anything else you would like to know about the responsibilities, technical stack, or experience level?

Thank you - that answers my questions for now. The role aligns well with my SC-300 certification and hands-on Entra ID and Active Directory labs. I'm interested in contributing to the team and expanding my experience with the other technologies you mentioned. I look forward to hearing from the recruiter about next steps.